

Finger gestures?

The Kinect motion controller for the Xbox 360 will reportedly support finger gestures

Motion sickness

According to a recent research, playing games can induce motion sickness

Kinect vs. Move vs. Wii

In the fight for gesture gaming dominance, who wins?



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THE SYSTEM

Thanks to a sophisticated depth-sensing camera (a single color camera for image recognition, and two monochrome cameras to determine three-dimensional location), Kinect can track your movements without a physical controller. You can navigate menus and play games without laying a finger on a piece of plastic. A microphone array lets users control the system using voice commands or hand-waves. Because the system is camera-only, it needs a lot of space; Microsoft recommends 6 to 8 feet between the Kinect sensor and the user.

The PlayStation Move is a technological cross between Kinect and the Nintendo Wii, combining a video camera with a physical controller. The Move Motion Controller, or "wand," combines a gyroscope, accelerometer, and magnetic sensor for tracking in three dimensions, while the glowing ball gives the PlayStation Eye camera a visual reference for motion sensing. Like Kinect, Sony recommends 5 to 9 feet between the player and the PlayStation Eye, but you can play anywhere from 2 to 10 feet of the camera.

Wii's remote, Wiimote houses an accelerometer that tracks movement, while an IR sensor on console monitor the positioning of lights emitted by the sensor bar. The addition of Wii MotionPlus, gives the Wiimote a gyroscope sensor, to complement the accelerometer, improving the motion detection greatly. Nintendo recently began to sell the Wii Remote Plus, a Wiimote with built-in gyroscope. The Wii's biggest weakness is its graphics; unlike the PlayStation 3 and Xbox 360, the Wii doesn't display high-definition content.

THE DEAL

Kinect costs ₹9,990.00, and includes a copy of the game, Kinect Adventures. If you don't have an Xbox 360, you can pick up a Kinect bundle, including a 4GB Xbox 360, for ₹22,990. And you only need Kinect itself for motion-controlled multiplayer games, unlike the Move and Wii.

The starter Kit which contains the Move controller, PS Eye Camera and a Demo Disc, costs Rs. 3650. The PS Move Controller alone is available for ₹2,499 and the PS Eye Camera for ₹1,499. For multiplayer games, you'll need at least one extra Move Motion Controller.

Unlike Kinect and PlayStation Move, the Wii's motion control system is integral to the console itself. If you have the console, you already have the motion control, the total system costing about ₹16,000 for everything you need.

GAMES

Currently, 17 Kinect games are available, including titles like sports mini-game compilation MotionSports, dance game Dance Central, and painfully cute virtual pet game Kinectimals.

Besides the bundled Sports Champions, there are several Move-exclusive games. Several existing or upcoming PS3 titles support Move control schemes, including Resident Evil 5, Heavy Rain, and LittleBigPlanet 2.

The Wii has been around since 2006, and it has a large library. More notable games include Mario Kart Wii, Rayman Raving Rabbids, Boom Blox, Red Steel 2, and many others.

PROS

Totally hands-free. Multiple players per Kinect and voice control works well.

Least expensive entry bundle. Very accurate motion tracking.

Inexpensive. Huge game library.

CONS

Requires a lot of space. Slightly more lag than PlayStation Move.

Requires a wand, sometimes two, depending on the game, for each player.

The least accurate motion sensing of the three systems. Not high-def.

VERDICT

Kinect offers both multiplayer motion gaming and voice-controlled menu navigation right out of the box. If you wedge it into the corner of a cramped studio apartment, though, you'll probably have some problems playing.

Sony's motion gaming system isn't quite as accessible as Kinect, where players can jump in and out of games without any calibration, but it tracks motion better than the Wii, and supports a broader range of games.

The Wii's been around the longest, and while both Kinect and PlayStation Move are more technically impressive with their advanced motion sensing and graphics, the Wii has the biggest library of motion-sensing games.